

DS GROUP PROPELS A GREENER HORIZON

DS Group showcases its Sustainable Development progress, encompassing governance, risk, and opportunity management, strategic initiatives, performance metrics, notable accomplishments, and comprehensive qualitative and quantitative data across economic, environmental, and social dimensions.

Various sustainability initiatives undertaken are in the areas of energy management, water management, material conservation, recycling & waste management, and enhancing green footprint. All of these have helped it in meeting the business, social, and environmental goals of the Group. We will continue our journey as a responsible corporate entity, deliver and build further momentum on our consistent track record for sustainable growth.

Currently, roughly half the world's ~8 billion people are estimated to experience severe water scarcity for at least some part of the year due to climatic and non-climatic factors. During the last two decades, the global glacier mass loss rate exceeded 0.5 meters of water equivalent per year, impacting humans and ecosystems. Agriculture and energy production have been impacted by changes in the hydrological cycle. Between 1983 and 2009, approximately three-quarters of the global harvested areas experienced yield losses induced by drought, with the cumulative production losses corresponding to USD 166 billion. (Source: IPCC_AR6_WGII_)

The impact is being experienced on a global, planetary scale, and directly within homes and communities. A thriving and healthy environment is a non-negotiable imperative and it is critical today to work towards sustainability and environmental well-being to nurture a happy society, a successful country, and a balanced world. Achievements can only be meaningful when it creates a renewable and supportive environmental, economic and social world. Many nations and governments are working towards this goal, and there has been a clarion call worldwide to come together for earth-first.

The DS Group's Vice Chairman Mr. Rajiv Kumar stated, "*In the pursuit of improved prospects for the future generations and safeguard our resources, we work to balance environmental, societal, and economic considerations. Our sustainability initiatives are spread across the country and in areas of energy management, water management, material conservation, recycling, and waste management. This aligns our business, social, and environmental objectives to make a significant contribution to society and the country. This fulfills our ethos of responsible growth while delivering superior value to all our stakeholders.*"

The DS Group has, very early on, recognized the huge potential that corporations and organizations hold to influence and transform the environment within its reach. The Group has led the way with intent and action.
A multi-business corporation, the DS Group is one of the leading FMCG conglomerate with a strong Indian and international presence. Founded in the year 1929, it is an inspiring and successful business story that blends a remarkable history and legacy with visionary growth. Guided by a clear set of values and built on a strong foundation of philanthropy, corporate responsibility is an integral part of the Group's business objectives to enhance livelihoods and build sustainable communities.

WATER CONSERVATION

Water is at the core of the sustainable well-being of humankind, serving crucial links between society, economics, and the environment. Realizing the vitality of water resources, the DS Group has been diligently undertaking cross-sectoral Integrated Water Conservation and Management projects, through its CSR activities in 6 states, benefitting millions of people from impoverished communities. The Group has developed more than 900 water-harvesting structures, with the cumulative capacity of around 80 lakh covering 2300 hectares of area under irrigation. Consequently, the crop productivity in the respective areas have increased many-fold.

The Water Economic Zone project by the DS Group and other interventions have been recognized and honored with the National Water Award, 2020 & FICCI Award (Category- Environmental Sustainability. The 'Water Economic Zone' project alone has benefitted 23000 tribal people in Alsigarh and Kurabad situated in the Udaipur district. The project has significantly improved the water table, introduced efficient irrigation techniques, and used solar energy in agriculture. This also potentially brought around 11000 hectares of land under double cropping. All these measures have led to an improved and sustainable economy for the local tribal communities. The project is further extended to four locations in Madhya Pradesh.

The Group aims to become water-neutral in the coming years.

A LEADING SYMBOL OF GREEN: THE WORLD'S NO 1 GREEN BUILDING IN INDIA

The DS Headquarters, housing the corporate office, an R & D Center with state of art manufacturing facilities has been awarded Leadership in